

Quantum Fault Tolerance Meets Toom's Contours

Michael Ben-Or David Ponomarevsky

May 17, 2026

1 Toric Encoded Circuits

Definition 1.1 (Toric Encoded Circuit). Let C be a quantum circuit. We say that C is *Toric encoded* if the following holds:

1. There is a Toric code $\mathcal{C}$ such that the qubits of $\mathcal{C}$ can be partitioned into registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, and each of the registers is encoded by $\mathcal{C}$.
2. The gates in C with even time coordinates are sweep decoding gates.

For a set of faults $\mathcal{E}$ the gates in $C[\mathcal{E}]$ can be decomposed to cycles, of the following form:

$$C = D_l P_l \Lambda_l, \dots, D_1 P_1 \Lambda_1$$

Definition 1.2 (Base graph G_o). Let C be a quantum circuit, at depth d , with registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, all of which are encoded by Toric codes with the same parameters (i.e., dimension, length, etc.). Let's denote by $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$ the Toric complexes that induce the codes. We define the base graph of C , denoted by $G_o = (V_o, E_o)$ as follows:

1. The vertices V_o are tuples, where the first coordinates correspond to a vertex in the union over the vertices in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, and the second coordinate is associated with a time. Namely:

$$V_o := \bigsqcup_i V(\mathcal{G}_i) \times [d]$$

2. The edges E_o are derived from the original edges in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, with the addition that any two vertices in preceding times t and $t + 1$ that support qubits (faces) such that C acts non-trivially on those qubits at time t are also connected by an edge. Namely:

$$E_o := \left\{ \{(v, t), (u, t')\} : \begin{array}{l} \text{either there exists } i \text{ such } \{v, u\} \in \mathcal{G}_i \text{ and } t' = t, t + 1 \\ \text{or there exists } u_i = (g_i, l_i) \in C \text{ such } v, u \in l_{i,2} \text{ and } t = l_{i,1}, t' = l_{i,1} + 1 \end{array} \right\}$$

[COMMENT] Here we should add that a vertex v belongs to location l if there is a qubit f that v belongs to its associated face.

Definition 1.3 (Time Graph of $C(\mathcal{E})$). For a quantum circuit C and set of faults $\mathcal{E}$, let us denote the base graph of $C[\mathcal{E}]$ by G_o . For each time t , denote the deviation induced by $\mathcal{E}$ at time t by $\mathcal{D}_t$, so $\partial\mathcal{D}_t$ is the syndrome that the qubits in the deviation admit. We define the history graph $\mathcal{H} = (V_{\mathcal{H}}, E_{\mathcal{H}})$ as follows:

1. The vertices $V_{\mathcal{H}}$ are taken to be the vertices of G_o , namely tuples $(v, t) \in V_o$, that satisfy that v belongs to a face associated with a check, which, at time t , belongs to the $\partial\mathcal{D}_t$. Namely:

$$\{v_t : v_t = (v, t) \in V_o \text{ and there exists a check } f \in C \text{ such } v \in f \in \partial\mathcal{D}_t\}$$

2. The edges $E_{\mathcal{H}}$ is partitioned into two types $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$, where $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ are the edges in E_o restricted to $V_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$ are defined to be the . Namely:

$$\begin{aligned} A_{\mathcal{H}} &= \{e = \{u, v\} \in E_o : u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}}\} \\ F_{\mathcal{H}} &= \{e = \{u, v\} : \text{exists } w \in V_{\mathcal{H}} \text{ such } \{v, w\}, \{u, w\} \in A_{\mathcal{H}}\} \end{aligned}$$

By definition of the construction, $G_{\mathcal{H}}$ is a time-graph.

Definition 1.4 (Size()-Function). Let S be a subset of vertices, we define the *size* of S to be:

$$\mathbf{Size}(S) := \sum_i^{d+1} \max_{v \in S} L_i(v)$$

Claim 1.5. Let $\mathbf{S} = \{S_1, S_2, \dots, S_k\}$ where $S_i \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, introduce an edge between S_i and S_j iff $S_i \cap S_j \neq \emptyset$. Assume that $\mathbf{S}$ is connected. Then $\mathbf{Size}(\cup_{i=1}^k S_i) \leq \sum_{i=1}^k \mathbf{Size}(S_i)$.

Proof. It suffices to prove that if $R_1 \cap R_2 \neq \emptyset$, then $\mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) \leq \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2)$. Let $a_{i,j} = \max_{v \in R_j} L_i(v)$. Then for any $w \in R_1 \cap R_2$ we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) &= \sum_i^{d+1} \max a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} = \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - \min a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} \\ &\leq \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - L_i(w) = \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) - \mathbf{Size}(w) \\ &= \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 1.6 (Size Invariant Action). [COMMENT] Here we classify both transversal gates, and rotation on the Toric. An action g is said size invariant action if, for any assignment z , it holds that $\mathbf{Size}(gz) = \mathbf{Size}(z)$.

Claim 1.7. The sweep rule is Size ξ -shrinking.

Proof.

□

[COMMENT] Eventually, we might not use the projected graph, and then we will split to history of the slices lemma for 3 parts. The first is when time = $3t$, in that we apply an invariant action so.